

Assignment 1

The goal of this assignment is to develop your business idea for a web application following the guidelines of the lecture. In doing so, you must discuss which customer segments you are targeting, and which problems your web application solves. Afterwards, develop and describe your business model based on the Business Model and Value Proposition Canvas template.

The results of this assignment lay the business foundation of your web application. In the second assignment, you will have to elaborate your results and provide a technical description of your business idea.

1. Description of the Assignment

Find a business idea for your web application and describe it clearly. Elaborate which customer segments you are targeting, and which of their pains your web application will address. Please respect the following general constraints:

- **Comply with EU legislation and German laws** (e.g., no drugs, no violation of copyright laws, no pornographic content).
- **Differentiate** yourself from existing solutions.
- Keep in mind that your web application must somehow generate **revenue**, i.e., it has to be self-sustainable.
- The web application must run in a **common web browser**.

Please use the **Value Proposition Canvas** (VPC) as presented in the lecture to sketch out your business idea. The VPC is a visual template that will help you in developing your business idea by explicitly outlining the targeted **customer segments** as well as the **value proposition** of your web application. Furthermore, it serves as a foundation for the development of your business model based on the **Business Model Canvas** (BMC).

The next step is to develop a **business model** of your idea, which builds upon the results of your VPC and is **based on the Business Model Canvas** (BMC) as presented in the lecture. You should focus on the components which are not yet covered by your VPC, i.e., you should outline your **key partners, activities**, and **resources** as well as the **cost structure** and **revenue streams** of your web application. However, the BMC template should be still filled out completely. Furthermore, map your business model to at least one of the business model categories as presented in the lecture. (Combinations and variations are possible.)

Please familiarize yourself with the VPC and BMC by checking out the templates provided via Moodle. Additionally, there is lots of material available on the web (e.g., <https://medium.com/pitchspot/the-business-model-canvas-explained-1f5b76207f7f>) and in the library (e.g., *Osterwalder & Pigneur (2010): Business Model Generation: A Handbook for Visionaries, Game Changers, and Challengers*).

2. Feedback Session

Please schedule a meeting with your advisor (onsite or online via Zoom). This meeting is mandatory and will provide you with valuable feedback before the submission deadline. Therefore, make sure that you have a first full draft of your deliverables that you can present to your advisor.

The presentation should include:

1. A pitch of your business idea
2. Description of your business model provided via the BMC

All team members should be familiar with the business idea and business model, and able to pitch the idea confidently.

3. Deliverables

A **paper** (in PDF format) describing your business idea and business model. This paper has to be structured as follows:

- A one sentence pitch of your business idea:
<name of your project / idea> is <a defined offering> to help <defined customer segment(s)> to <solve a problem> with/by <secret sauce>.
- 1 page containing a sketch of the filled-out VPC
- 1 page containing a sketch of the filled-out BMC
- Approx. 3 pages explaining the project idea and business model based on the BMC structure, i.e.,
 - i. Customer Segments
 - ii. Value Propositions
 - iii. Customer Relationships
 - iv. Channels
 - v. Key Activities
 - vi. Key Resources
 - vii. Key Partners
 - viii. Cost Structure
 - ix. Revenue Streams
- At most one page describing how your business model maps to the business model categories as presented in the lecture.
(Combinations and variations are possible.)

4. Submission of Deliverables

- All deliverables must be pushed into your team's project on LRZ GitLab. You will be added to a group on GitLab by the organizer. (Please be patient if this has not happened yet.)
- Push deliverables into the 'deliverables' repository. The 'backend' and 'frontend' repositories should only be used for code.

5. Evaluation

The assignment is evaluated according to the following guidelines:

- Quality and structure of the business idea according to the guidelines of the lecture, the VPC, and BMC
- Style and structure of the documents ("corporate design")

The grade of this assignment counts 10% towards the overall final grade.

Submission deadline and feedback session timeframe can be found [HERE](#).